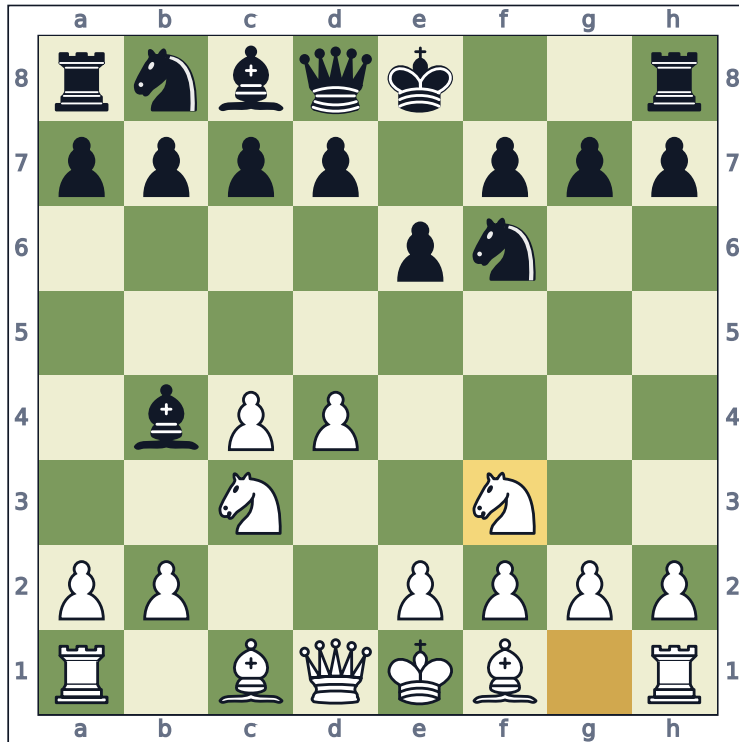


NIMZO-INDIAN DEFENSE

Nimzo-Indian Defense

ECO E21 | 4 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.24 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

E21 covers Nimzo-Indian Defense. Black pins the c3 knight and fights for e4, often exchanging a bishop for structural control or rapid development. The diagram uses the featured line Nimzo-Indian Defense: Three Knights Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Nf3

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Use the bishop pair and central space, manage doubled pawns constructively, and decide whether e4 or a queenside advance is realistic.

BLACK'S GOALS

Pressure c4/e4, exploit weak squares, and choose the right moment to surrender or preserve the dark-squared bishop.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

Black uses ...c5, ...d5, or ...e5; White often seeks e4, d5, or queenside expansion with a3 and b4.

PIECE MAP

The c3 knight, e4 square, and bishop-pair decision are the strategic core. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Doubled pawns are not automatically weak: activity, open files, and central control may compensate fully. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on c4, White pawn on d4, Black pawn on e6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

One of Black's very best defenses to 1.d4, rich enough for a lifetime of study.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named E21 line

This section preserves all 4 names and defining routes assigned to E21 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Nimzo-Indian Defense: Three Knights Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Nf3

002 Nimzo-Indian Defense: Three Knights Variation, Euwe Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Nf3 c5 5. d5 Ne4

003 Nimzo-Indian Defense: Three Knights Variation, Korchnoi Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Nf3 c5 5. d5

004 Nimzo-Indian Defense: Three Knights Variation, Shocron Gambit

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 Bb4+ 4. Nc3 c5 5. d5 b5